

ART & CULTURE



INDIAN ARCHITECTURE

MODULE - 3

ART AND ARCHITECTURE OF HARAPPAN PERIOD (PART-1)

INTRODUCTION

“If I were asked under what sky the human mind has most fully developed some of its choicest gifts, has most deeply pondered on to the greatest problems of life and has found the solutions, I should point to India.”

- Max Mueller.



BRIHADISVARA TEMPLE, THANJAVUR

1 We belong to that civilization which has spanned at least 4,500 years and has left its impact on nearly everything in our lives and society.

2 Many generations have been a part of this architectural heritage which stands mighty and lofty reminding us of that glorious past which has been ours.

3 Many distinctive features that we find in the architecture today have developed throughout the long period of Indian history.

INTRODUCTION

- 4 The earliest and most remarkable evidence of Indian architecture is found in the cities of Harappan civilization which boast of a unique town planning.



- 5 In the post Harappan period the architectural styles have been classified as Hindu, Buddhist, and Jain.
- 6 The medieval periods are the **synthesis of Persian and indigenous style of architecture**. Thereafter the colonial period brought the influence of western architectural forms to India.
- 7 Thus, Indian Architecture is the synthesis of indigenous styles and external influences which has lent it a unique characteristic of its own.

PIETRA DURA WORK OF MUGHALS

ARCHITECTURE- IT'S STORY OF EVOLUTION



HUMAYUN'S TOMB, DELHI

- 1** Indian Architecture was not a modern phenomenon.
- 2** It began as soon as the early cave man began to build his own shelter to live in.
- 3** From the ancient Harappan civilization to the British rule, the buildings and sculptures have a narrative of their own.
- 4** The emergence and decay of great empires, the invasion of foreign rulers, the confluence of different styles and cultures etc., are all reflected in the evolution of Indian Architecture.

ARCHITECTURE- IT'S STORY OF EVOLUTION



RANI-KI-VAV IN PATAN, GUJARAT

Why was Rani-ki-Vav recently seen in news?

- 5** Architecture accommodated both the local and regional cultural traditions and social requirements, economic prosperity, religious practices of different types.
- 6** Hence the study of architecture reveals to us, the cultural diversities and help us understand the rich traditions of India.
- 7** Indian Architecture evolved in various stages in different parts and regions of the Country. Let us now take a look at the process of the evolution of the Indian Architecture.

HARAPPAN PERIOD



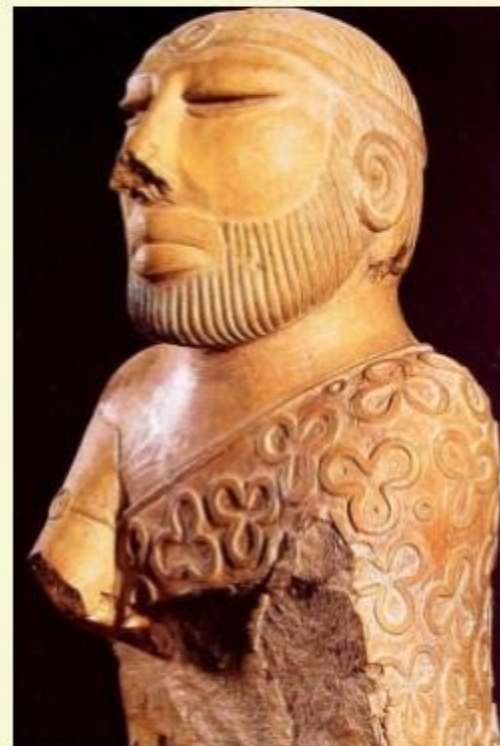
- 1** The excavations at Harappa and Mohenjo daro and several other cities of the Indus Valley Civilization revealed the existence of the modern-urban civilization with expert town-planning and engineering skills.
- 2** The very advanced drainage system along with well-planned roads and houses show that a sophisticated and highly evolved culture existed in India before the coming of Aryans.

SALIENT FEATURES OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

- 1** This Ancient civilization was very well-known for the vivid imagination and artistic sensibilities exuded by the numerous sculptures, seals, potteries, jewelleryes found at the excavation sites.



- 2** Harappa and Mohenjo daro, the two major sites of this civilization, are among the earliest and finest examples of Urban-Civic Planning.



SALIENT FEATURES OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

POINT NO: 1

URBAN GROWTH



- 1** One of the most important features and achievements of this culture was the growth of urban centers and cities.
- 2** After its extinction, such an advanced city and urban centers emerged only a thousand years later in the Indian Sub-Continent.
- 3** The important urban centers discovered so far are Harappa, Mohenjo daro in the present day Pakistan and Lothal, Dholavira, Kalibangan, Rakhigarhi in India.
- 4** Among these, the Harappan site is the earliest discovered site, but the site of Mohenjo daro was the better preserved site.

SALIENT FEATURES OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

POINT NO: 2

TOWN-PLANNING



CITADEL OF MOHENJO DARO

- 1** The town of Mohenjo daro is divided into two parts. The smaller but higher portion is designated as the **citadel**, and lower but larger settlement is referred to as the **lower town**.
- 2** Such division of settlement into a **citadel/ acropolis** and a **lower town** is also noted in other urban centres and also can indicate the division of its urban society in to two parts.
- 3** The citadel which was built on an upraised platform had walls fortifying it from all sides.

SALIENT FEATURES OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

POINT NO: 2

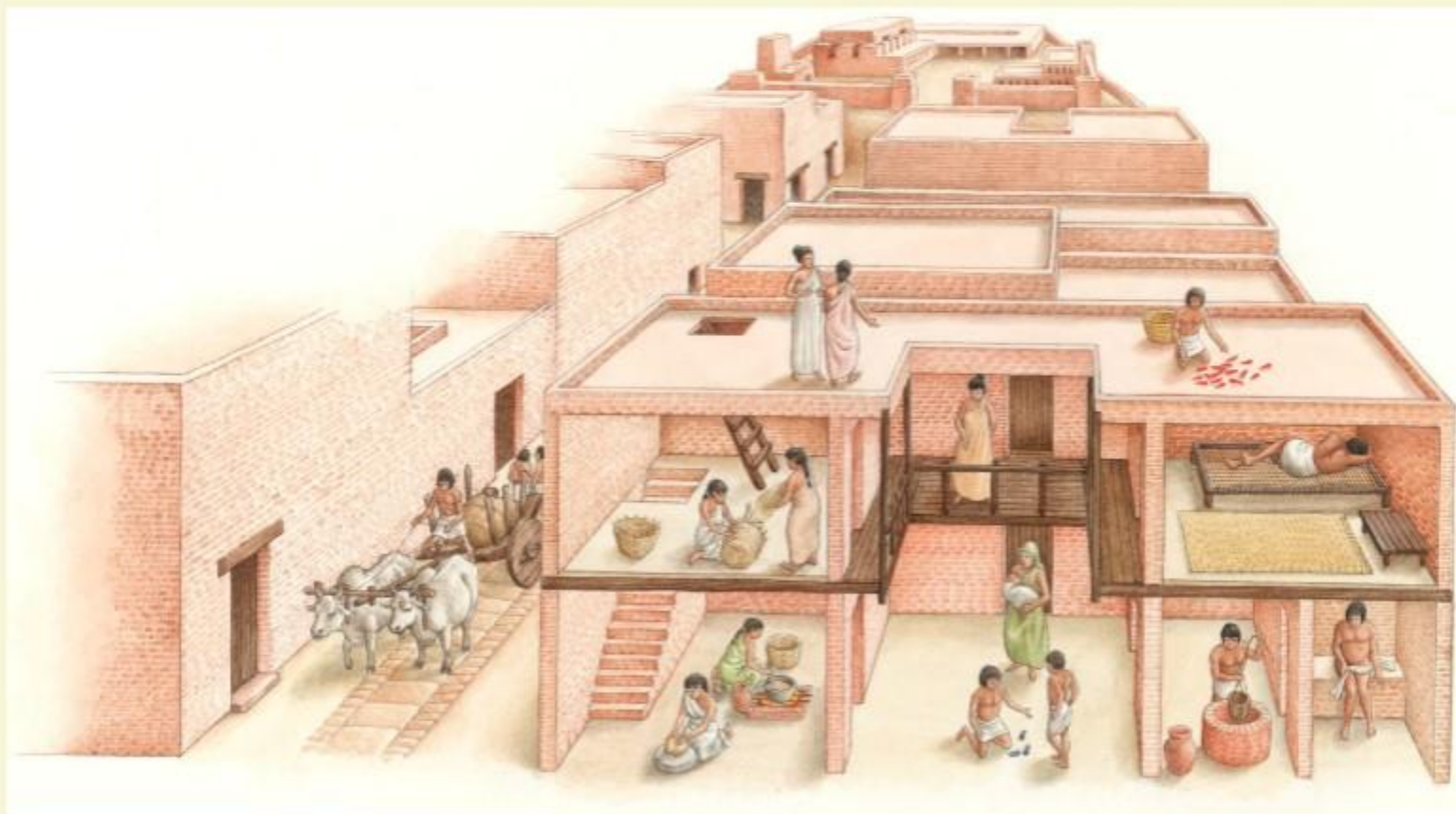
TOWN-PLANNING



- 4 This was used for buildings of large dimensions such as granaries, administrative buildings, pillared halls and courtyard.
- 5 Some of the buildings in citadels might have been the residence of the rulers and aristocrats.
- 6 The lower town was of much larger area than the citadel. Like the citadel it was walled perhaps to keep the floods away.

TOWN-PLANNING

7 The lower part of the city might have been used as quarters by working class people. Some of the stairs present in the buildings indicate that they might have been double storeyed.



SALIENT FEATURES OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

POINT NO: 2

TOWN-PLANNING

8 The bricks were of standard size and ratio and similar standardized bricks were employed in all settlements in this culture.



9 Most buildings have private wells and bathrooms and are properly ventilated.



SALIENT FEATURES OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

POINT NO: 3

STREETS AND TOWN-PLANNING



- 1 The main streets of the cities at both Harappa and Mohenjo-Daro were generally oriented from north to south, with connecting streets running east to west.
- 2 The streets along with efficient drainage system seems to have been constructed first and the houses built around them were constructed later indicating existence of advanced town-planning.

SALIENT FEATURES OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

POINT NO: 4

THE DRAINAGE SYSTEM



Private Wells

- 1 The architectural excellence of this civilization could be witnessed in the **efficient drainage system** which was not found amidst other contemporary civilization.
- 2 Each house had its own private drinking well and bathroom which was well connected with drains.

SALIENT FEATURES OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

POINT NO: 4

THE DRAINAGE SYSTEM



Earliest known toilets of
Harappan Culture

3 The water from these bathrooms ran through **clay pipes** into **underground drains** which ran into main drain.

4 These main drains were made up of bricks **set in mortar** and had large **cross-sections** to accommodate even a large water flow.

SALIENT FEATURES OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

POINT NO: 4

THE DRAINAGE SYSTEM

- 5 The above is indicative of not only the advancement in municipal system and importance attached to social and personal hygiene but also of proper planning and good knowledge of brick mortar construction.



SALIENT FEATURES OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

POINT NO: 5

THE GREAT BATH

- 1 An important feature of the Harappans city is the prevalence of **public baths**, which indicate the importance of ritualistic cleaning in their culture.



- 2 These baths also had an array of galleries and rooms surrounding it.
- 3 The most famous example of a public bath is the **Great Bath** excavated remains of Mohenjo-Daro.
- 4 That there are no cracks or leaks in the Great Bath **speaks volumes about the engineering acumen** of the Harappan civilization.
- 5 This structure is **rectangular in shape**. It was accessible from two-wide staircases on the Northern and Southern side.

SALIENT FEATURES OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

DOMESTIC HOUSE PLANNING AND ARCHITECTURE

POINT NO: 6



Well-baked bricks joined using gypsum mortar

- 1 The domestic house planning and architecture is well evident from the lower town of the Mohenjo-Daro.
- 2 Mainly three buildings are found in the excavation sites- dwelling houses, public buildings and public baths.
- 3 The Harappans used burnt mud bricks of standardized dimension for the purpose of construction.
- 4 Many layers of well-baked bricks were laid out and then joined together using gypsum mortar.

SALIENT FEATURES OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

DOMESTIC HOUSE PLANNING AND ARCHITECTURE

POINT NO: 6



Drainage System

- 5 The houses were constructed along the roads and drains (which were planned and constructed first).
- 6 Each of the houses is centered around a courtyard with rooms built around it.
- 7 The courtyard could be the centre of household activities.
- 8 Each house had a separate bathroom with a well the discharge of which would run in the system of drains.

SALIENT FEATURES OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

POINT NO: 7

GREAT GRANARY

- 1 Evidence has also been found of a **large ware-house type structure** at Harappa which is also referred to as the “**Great Granary**”.



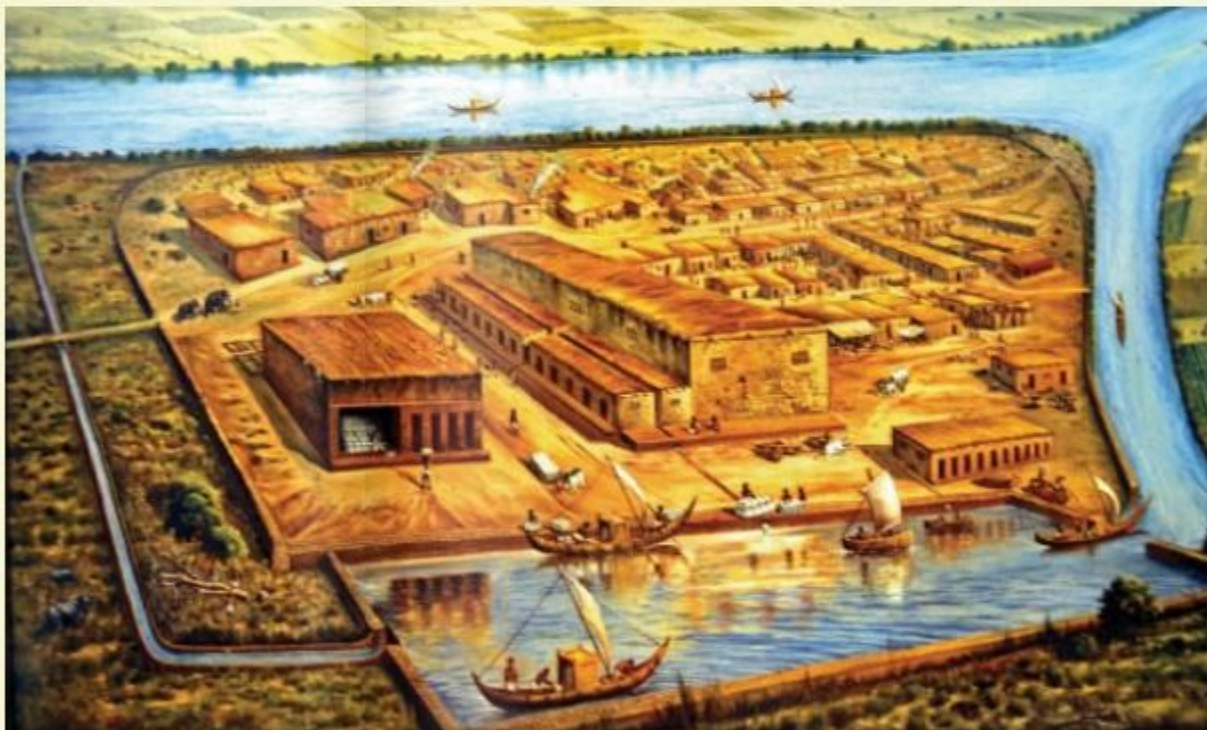
*Great Granary at
Harappa*

SALIENT FEATURES OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

DOCKYARD AT LOTHAL

POINT NO: 8

- 1 The existence of a channel based docking system at Lothal (mound of dead) in the state of Gujarat is an important find of Harappan culture.



An artistic depiction of dockyard in Lothal

- 2 The dockyard was connected to river channel through which boats could reach the sea following the tidal system.
- 3 The dock and the channel could be locked during a low tide and unlocked during a high tide, thus allowing navigation.
- 4 Bead making, jewellery making flourished in this center. It was also an important trading town.

SALIENT FEATURES OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

POINT NO: 9

INDUS SCRIPT



- 1 The Indus script has not been deciphered yet as it is a pictographic one.
- 2 A large number of characters of this type have been discovered so far primarily on the numerous seals and ceramic pots excavated
- 3 What is known is that the characters were written from right to left, as in some seals/inscriptions many characters are seen to be squeezed for want of space towards the left end.

SALIENT FEATURES OF THE HARAPPAN CULTURE

POINT NO: 10

WEIGHTS AND MEASURES



- 1 The Harappan culture had also developed an accurate system of weights and measures.
- 2 The weights were made of cubical piece of stones called cherts. They show that in weighing mostly 16 or its multiples were used; for instance 16, 64, 160, 320 and so on.
- 3 These accurate weights and measures are their gifts to us. All of this indicate the advancement in science and mathematics and the growth of trade and commerce in the Harappan Civilization.

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